

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Obon; B) Mikoshi; C) Omizutori; D) Tanabata

Note: Obon is a traditional Japanese festival that celebrates the return of the spirits of deceased ancestors, during which families honor their loved ones by making ritual offerings of food.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Community; B) Scripture; C) Worship; D) Apprenticeship

Note: The phrase Guru-Panth refers to the collective community of Sikhs who follow the teachings of the Gurus, emphasizing the importance of unity and shared beliefs within the faith.

3. **Answer:** D

Options: A) Honor Killing; B) Stoning; C) Adultery; D) Polygyny

Note: The Qur'an permits polygyny, which is the practice of a man having multiple wives, as it is explicitly mentioned in Surah An-Nisa (4:3), allowing Muslim men to marry up to four wives under certain conditions, emphasizing fairness and justice among them.

4. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Andal; B) Devi; C) Ganga; D) Kali

Note: Andal is celebrated as a revered female poet-saint in the Bhakti movement, known for her devotional poems dedicated to Lord Vishnu, and she is uniquely honored in numerous South Indian temples.

5. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Julian of Norwich; B) Catherine of Siena; C) Teresa of Avila; D) John of the Cross

Note: Julian of Norwich believed that evil serves as a contrast that ultimately highlights and reveals God's unconditional love and mercy, a key concept in her theological reflections.

True / False

6. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Laozi is considered the founder of Daoism, and his teachings emphasize the importance of aligning one's life with the Dao, which represents the fundamental nature of the universe and the path to harmony.

7. **Answer:** False
Options: A) True; B) False
Note: The term "xin" in Chinese philosophy primarily refers to the concept of trustworthiness and sincerity, rather than piety or religious devotion.
8. **Answer:** False
Options: A) True; B) False
Note: The concept of 'Kama' in dharma texts refers specifically to desire or pleasure, one of the four goals of life, rather than the four stages of life, which are known as Ashramas.
9. **Answer:** True
Options: A) True; B) False
Note: Sri Lakshmi is indeed the goddess worshipped during Divali, as she represents wealth, prosperity, and abundance in Hindu tradition, making the statement true.
10. **Answer:** True
Options: A) True; B) False
Note: The Rabbinical period in Judaism began after the destruction of the Second Temple in 70 CE because this event marked a significant shift from temple-based worship to a focus on rabbinic teachings and synagogues as centers of Jewish life and practice.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** Aum Shinrikyo, founded by Shoko Asahara in the 1980 s, believed in the necessity of cleansing Japanese society through apocalyptic events to prepare for a new world. The group combined elements of Buddhism, Hinduism, and apocalyptic Christianity, seeing themselves as the only true path to salvation amidst societal decay. Their motivations stemmed from a conviction that a catastrophic event, such as a nuclear war, would ultimately lead to a spiritual awakening and purification. This reflects a broader theme in religious movements where followers often seek to address perceived moral or social failures through drastic measures, believing that transformation can only come through significant upheaval. Aum's extreme actions highlight how some groups may interpret religious teachings in ways that lead to violence in pursuit of their vision of societal renewal.
Note: correct because it accurately outlines Aum Shinrikyo's belief in cleansing society through apocalyptic events as a means to achieve spiritual awakening, illustrating how their motivations align with broader themes of religious movements that often involve a narrative of societal decay and the promise of renewal.
12. **Answer:** Honen was a pivotal figure in the development of Pure Land Buddhism in Japan during the 12 th century. He emphasized the practice of calling upon Amitabha Buddha through the nembutsu, "Namu Amida Butsu," as a means to attain rebirth in the Pure Land, a place of enlightenment. His teachings made Buddhism more accessible to the common people by focusing on faith rather than complex rituals or strict

monastic practices. Today, Honen's influence can be seen in contemporary Buddhist practices that prioritize simplicity, devotion, and community, encouraging followers to rely on Amitabha's compassion for salvation. This approach continues to resonate, fostering a sense of hope and spiritual connection among practitioners.

Note: correct because it accurately identifies Honen's central role in popularizing Pure Land Buddhism through the emphasis on the nembutsu as a simple and accessible practice for attaining enlightenment, thus illustrating his lasting influence on contemporary Buddhist practices.